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AXFORD REAL ESTATE · PORT MOODY · OCTOBER 2026

Moving to the Tri-Cities

Coquitlam, Port Coquitlam, Port Moody, Anmore and Belcarra. The insider's guide.



Devin Desaulniers
Real Estate Associate, Axford Real Estate
I work in Port Moody. I play soccer in PoCo.

Axford real estate

THREE CITIES, TWO VILLAGES

Start here

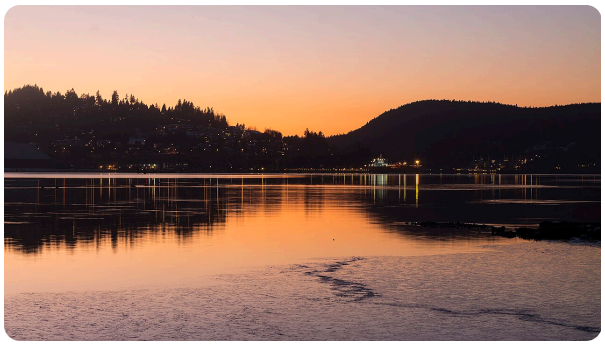


Axford Real Estate is at 2326 Clarke Street in Port Moody. I've lived in Greater Vancouver for 28 years and I've been licensed since 2020. "Tri-Cities" means Coquitlam, Port Coquitlam and Port Moody. Anmore and Belcarra are the villages just north. They show up in the same search. They are not the same errand pattern.

Figures checked 11 October 2026, and they change. Asking rents: Rentals.ca, September 2026, published 7 October. Benchmarks: Greater Vancouver REALTORS®, September 2026, published 2 October. CMHC bedroom rents: October 2025 survey. This is not legal, tax or mortgage advice. The wider region is in the Greater Vancouver guide.



Lafarge Lake, Town Centre Park. Greg Salter, CC BY 2.5, via Wikimedia Commons.



Rocky Point Park. Jeff Macleod, CC BY-SA 3.0, via Wikimedia Commons.

COQUITLAM

The largest of the three

From the Fraser up to Burke Mountain and Westwood Plateau. City Centre — Coquitlam Centre, Lafarge Lake, Town Centre Park — is what the SkyTrain was aimed at. September 2026 composite **$971,700** (−6.3%). Detached $1,584,400. Townhouse $976,600. Apartment $640,100. Names on listings: Burke Mountain, Westwood Plateau, City Centre, Burquitlam, Austin Heights, Maillardville, Ranch Park, Eagle Ridge. The hill is more house and more of a drive. City Centre is the station and the mall. The commute usually decides it.

PORT COQUITLAM

PoCo

Between the Coquitlam and Pitt rivers. A walkable downtown, the Traboulay PoCo Trail, Terry Fox's hometown, and where I play soccer. September composite **$835,500** (−8.2%), the lowest of the three. Detached $1,240,600. Townhouse $834,300. Apartment $550,000. Names: Downtown PoCo, Citadel Heights, Mary Hill, Oxford Heights, Lincoln Park, Riverwood, Birchland Manor, Glenwood. No SkyTrain. West Coast Express at the Kingsway station, weekday rush hour, and the R3 RapidBus on Lougheed Highway.

PORT MOODY

Head of the inlet

The city calls itself the City of the Arts. Rocky Point, the Shoreline Trail, and Brewers Row on Murray Street are local favourites. My office is on Clarke Street. September composite **$1,011,500** (−5.8%). Detached $1,903,500. Townhouse $940,900. Apartment $676,200. Do not average the house and the condo. Names: Moody Centre, Inlet Centre and Suter Brook, Newport Village, Heritage Mountain, Heritage Woods, College Park, Glenayre, Ioco. The first two have SkyTrain. The hill neighbourhoods are a drive down to it.

ANMORE & BELCARRA

The villages

Larger, treed lots, and a car for most trips. Buntzen Lake is in Anmore. təmtəmíx̱ʷtən/Belcarra Regional Park and Sasamat Lake are why the rest of the region drives up. No separate GVR benchmark — I will not invent one. Nearest SkyTrain and West Coast Express are in Port Moody. Bus 182 runs from Moody Centre to Belcarra and stops at Anmore Grocery. Map the grocery trip before you fall for a lot. Anmore lot size can also affect the property-transfer-tax exemption, which is generally limited to 0.5 hectares for the full amount.

WHAT A LISTING COSTS

Rents

Rentals.ca published one Tri-Cities asking figure for September 2026: **Coquitlam apartments and condos, $2,497**. It did not publish Port Moody, Port Coquitlam, or a bedroom split. For scale, Vancouver was $2,741, Burnaby $2,548, Richmond $2,572. Those are vacant listings.

CMHC, OCTOBER 2025	STUDIO	1 BED	2 BED	3+	ALL
Coquitlam	$1,637 b	$1,692 b	$2,148 b	$2,737 b	$1,909 b
Port Coquitlam	—	$1,634 b	$2,095 c	—	$1,918 b
Port Moody	—	—	—	$1,905 d	$2,284 d
Vancouver CMA	$1,667 a	$1,807 a	$2,364 a	$2,820 a	$1,970 a

Purpose-built rentals, occupied and vacant. a excellent, b very good, c good, d poor. Port Moody's row is too weak to budget from. A new tower at Inlet Centre and an older walk-up in Maillardville are not the same product. Basement suites and rented condos are outside this table.

SEPTEMBER 2026

Benchmark prices

AREA	COMPOSITE	DETACHED	TOWNHOUSE	APARTMENT
Coquitlam	$971,700 (−6.3%)	$1,584,400 (−6.6%)	$976,600 (−6.5%)	$640,100 (−7.3%)
Port Coquitlam	$835,500 (−8.2%)	$1,240,600 (−8.5%)	$834,300 (−7.8%)	$550,000 (−9.0%)
Port Moody	$1,011,500 (−5.8%)	$1,903,500 (−8.4%)	$940,900 (−5.2%)	$676,200 (−4.9%)
Greater Vancouver	$1,075,900 (−5.5%)	$1,784,700 (−7.3%)	$1,016,700 (−4.7%)	$682,500 (−6.2%)

MLS HPI benchmarks. Port Moody detached and PoCo detached are different markets. Region-wide, September sales were 1,717, down 8.4%, with the drop concentrated in apartments. Sales-to-active ratio 10.9%.

EVERGREEN IS THE MILLENNIUM LINE

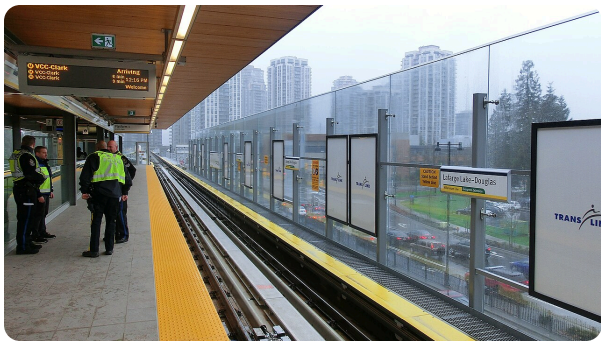
Transit

Original schematic of SkyTrain and the West Coast Express

Station order after Lougheed Town Centre: **Burquitlam** (Clarke Road, Coquitlam) → **Moody Centre** (Port Moody, also West Coast Express) → **Inlet Centre** (loco Road and Barnet Highway) → **Coquitlam Central** (also West Coast Express) → **Lincoln** (Coquitlam Centre) → **Lafarge Lake–Douglas** (Pinetree and Guildford, beside Town Centre Park). Lincoln is the mall. Lafarge Lake is the park. People mix them up.



Moody Centre station. Northwest, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons.



Lafarge Lake–Douglas, the end of the line. Northwest, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons.

Fares, October 2026. Three zones remain. Buses are 1-zone all day. SkyTrain is zoned on weekday daytimes and 1-zone after 6:30 p.m., all weekend, and statutory holidays. Compass Card: $6 refundable deposit. Adult stored value $2.85 / $4.20 / $5.40. Cash or tap $3.50 / $5.10 / $6.70. Monthly pass $117.20 / $156.70 / $211.65. Children 12 and under ride free. A fare lasts 90 minutes. Count zones on TransLink's map for your stations before you buy a pass. I am not labelling every Tri-Cities-to-downtown ride "3-zone" without that check. Evening and weekend rides are 1-zone either way.

West Coast Express uses separate zones. Moody Centre, Coquitlam Central and Port Coquitlam are 3 of those zones from Waterfront. Weekdays only, five trains each way, mornings toward downtown, late afternoons toward Mission. Mission City to Waterfront is 75 minutes on the published timetable. Read the current timetable for the Tri-Cities stops rather than a guessed minute. Parking was $3 a day or $60 a month. A West Coast Express return or monthly includes bus and SkyTrain that day. A SkyTrain pass does not replace it.

Buses. The R3 Lougheed Hwy RapidBus runs Coquitlam Central to Haney Place via Port Coquitlam. The 182 is the Belcarra bus and the Anmore Grocery stop BC Hydro mentions for Buntzen. The 160 runs Port Coquitlam Station through Coquitlam Central and Moody Centre to Kootenay Loop on Hastings. I am not quoting a frequency I could not confirm.

In-vehicle SkyTrain time to Waterfront, from TransLink's chart, plus a transfer at Commercial–Broadway: Coquitlam Central 32 + 10 = 42 minutes. Lafarge Lake–Douglas 35 + 10 = 45. Add the wait. Peak Expo trains are published every 2–5 minutes, Millennium every 3–4. I will not print a driving-time table for Barnet, Lougheed or Highway 1. Those roads are a different trip at 7:30 and at 10.

THE REASON PEOPLE LOOK HERE

Parks, shops, schools



Buntzen Lake, Anmore. Patrick Leahy, CC BY 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons.



White Pine Beach, Sasamat Lake, in February. Dennis Sylvester Hurd, CC0, via Wikimedia Commons. July does not look like this.

Buntzen Lake

BC Hydro, in Anmore. Parking is free. In recent summers, roughly mid-May through early September, you still need a free online pass released in the morning for the next day. No pass, no entry by car. Dates change — check bchydro.com/buntzen. No public parking in the village. The 182 does not need a pass. About a 30-minute walk from Anmore Grocery to South Beach.

Belcarra

Metro Vancouver's təmtəmíxʷtən/Belcarra Regional Park: beach, Sasamat Lake, Woodhaven Swamp, Admiralty Point Trail (about 6 km and 1.5 hours, rocky shoreline). On a hot weekend, locals go early.

In the cities

Rocky Point Park, 2800 Murray Street: pier, playground, Shoreline Trail, kayak rental. Mundy Park, 641 Hillcrest: 178 hectares, 5.5 km loop, about an hour. Town Centre Park, 1299 Pinetree: 42 hectares on Lafarge Lake, at the last station. PoCo's long walk is the Traboulay PoCo Trail and the river dikes. It is flat. Burke Mountain is not.

Burke Mountain

City loops of about 2 km and 3.2 km from Harper Park, some steep sections. Beyond that, Pinecone Burke Provincial Park: BC Parks says much of the backcountry infrastructure is in poor condition and signage is incomplete.

Shopping. Coquitlam Centre, at Lincoln station, is about 930,000 square feet and nearly 200 stores. The mall lists Walmart, Best Buy, London Drugs, Sport Chek, T&T, UNIQLO, H&M, Sephora and lululemon, and about 4,000 stalls. Suter Brook (near Inlet Centre) and Newport Village (across from City Hall and the library) are mixed-use streets. Suter Brook has included Thrifty Foods. Brewers Row on Murray Street and Rocky Point Ice Cream are local favourites, not a ranking. PoCo's downtown is the smaller main street.

Schools. School District No. 43 (Coquitlam) serves all five communities. Catchment is the permanent address and boundaries change. Use the district's School Locator after you have an address. Secondary schools on the district's 2025–26 contact list, as examples only: Centennial, Dr. Charles Best, Gleneagle and Pinetree in Coquitlam; Heritage Woods and Port Moody Secondary in Port Moody; Riverside and Terry Fox in Port Coquitlam. Burnaby is SD41. Vancouver is SD39. A city boundary is a district boundary.

Healthcare. MSP: apply on arrival. Wait is the rest of the arrival month plus two months, waived for returning Canadians, permanent residents, CUEAT arrivals, and discharged CAF families. Health Connect Registry for a family doctor — no official wait estimate. Eagle Ridge Hospital, 475 Guildford Way, Port Moody, 604-461-2022, is the local emergency. Royal Columbian in New Westminster is the Level 1 trauma centre. Know which is which.

Setup. ICBC licence exchange within 90 days. BC Hydro electricity, account up to 60 days ahead, $13.50 + GST on the first bill. FortisBC gas in Coquitlam, PoCo, Port Moody and Anmore — confirm the address has it. TELUS PureFibre, Rogers on the former Shaw network, Novus only in some buildings. Rain: Vancouver Harbour averages 1,537 mm a year and 245 mm in November. Burke Mountain and the villages are higher and see more snow than Clarke Street. I am not quoting a Port Moody climate table I do not have.

MONEY AND PAPERWORK

Renting, then buying costs

- Security deposit at most half a month. Pet deposit, if any, at most another half. Not first-and-last.
- Application fees are illegal (Residential Tenancy Act, s. 15).
- 2026 rent-increase limit 2.3%. 2027 is 2.2%. Once a year. Three full months' notice.
- RTB-27 condition inspection. Copy in 7 days at move-in, 15 at move-out. That is the deposit fight, if there is one.
- Residential Tenancy Branch: $100 to file, 1-800-665-8779.

> See the suite yourself or on a live video from inside it. A price far under Coquitlam's $2,497 asking average, plus pressure to pay today by wire or crypto, is the pattern. Listings usually appear a few weeks before they are free. Plan the active search for about 4–6 weeks before you need keys.

Property transfer tax. 1% to $200,000, 2% to $2,000,000, 3% above that, plus a further 2% on the residential portion above $3,000,000.

PoCo's September apartment benchmark is $550,000. Ordinary tax is $2,000 + 2% of $350,000 = **$9,000**. A qualifying first-time buyer in the $500,000–$835,000 band gets an $8,000 exemption, so **$1,000** would remain if every other test is met. Port Moody's apartment benchmark ($676,200) is in that band. Port Moody's detached benchmark ($1,903,500) is not: the first-time exemption is zero at $860,000 and above. Full exemption applies at $500,000 or less. You must meet citizenship or permanent-residence, residence, and "never owned a principal residence" tests, and live there.

A qualifying newly built principal residence can be fully exempt up to $1,100,000. Coquitlam's townhouse benchmark, $976,600, is under that. Ordinary tax on it is $17,532. Foreign buyers can owe an extra 20% on their share in Metro Vancouver. GST on many new homes is separate. None of this is tax advice.

ORDER OF OPERATIONS

First 30 days

BEFORE

- Choose the city from the station you will use.
- Budget from live listings, not the CMHC row.
- Book Hydro, and gas if the home has it.
- Order internet for the civic address.
- If you want a search done for you, start 4–6 weeks out.

WEEK ONE

- File MSP. Insure the gap.
- Walk the suite. Sign RTB-27.
- Ride the weekday morning commute before you buy a pass.
- Health Connect Registry.
- Book ICBC. Find Eagle Ridge on a map.

BY DAY 30

- SD43 locator for the signed address.
- Each city has its own garbage calendar.
- Learn the Buntzen pass before summer.
- Walk the Shoreline or Mundy in the rain.
- If the hill is wrong, say so before the lease gets long.

FROM A WEEKDAY HERE

Things locals know

Three cities, two villages. Different city halls. Anmore is not north Port Moody.

You don't transfer to Evergreen. You stay on the Millennium Line.

Inlet Centre and Moody Centre are both Port Moody and they are not the same walk. Suter Brook is at Inlet Centre. Clarke Street is at Moody Centre.

Buntzen's pass is the whole plan on a summer Saturday. Free, and still required in recent seasons.

CMHC's $1,692 Coquitlam 1-bedroom is not the rent on a listing this month.

Eagle Ridge is the local ER. Royal Columbian is the trauma centre, in New Westminster.

PoCo has no SkyTrain. "The train" may mean a service that does not run at noon.

Lincoln is the mall. Lafarge Lake is the park. One stop apart.

The hill is a lifestyle. Heritage Mountain, Westwood Plateau and Burke Mountain are a drive down to the train on a dark morning.

Half a month's rent is the legal deposit ceiling.

SD43 does not follow a sentence in a listing. The locator follows the address.

November is a season. The mountain gets more weather than Clarke Street.

CHECKED 11 OCTOBER 2026

Sources

1. Rentals.ca October 2026 National Rent Report, 7 October 2026, for Coquitlam's $2,497 and the comparison cities.
2. CMHC October 2025 Rental Market Survey, tables published 11 December 2025.
3. GVR September 2026 statistics package and 2 October 2026 release.
4. TransLink SkyTrain schedules, West Coast Express timetable and fares, zone and Compass prices, station-to-station travel times. Evergreen station municipalities confirmed in the B.C. government release of 23 March 2013; the names are the ones still on the system.
5. School District 43, including its 2025–26 school contact list. MSP wait period. Health Connect Registry. Eagle Ridge Hospital. Royal Columbian Hospital.
6. Residential Tenancy Act ss. 15 and 19. Provincial rent-increase limits for 2026 and 2027. Property transfer tax, first-time buyers' exemption, newly built home exemption.
7. BC Hydro Buntzen Lake page. City of Coquitlam: Mundy Park and the trail system. City of Port Moody: Rocky Point Park. Metro Vancouver: təmtəmíxʷtən/Belcarra Regional Park. BC Parks: Pinecone Burke. Coquitlam Centre's own site. ICBC moving-to-B.C. pages. BC Hydro new customer. FortisBC. Environment Canada normals, Vancouver Harbour, 1991–2020.

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AXFORD REAL ESTATE · PORT MOODY

Tell me the station and the move date.

Tenant-side rental search: $1,500 + GST, paid by the tenant. $750 at the start, non-refundable. $750 when a rental is secured. At 5% GST, the tax is $75. I search Greater Vancouver, with a focus on these cities. Showings in person or on live video. We read the lease before you sign.



Devin Desaulniers
Real Estate Associate
Call or text 604-809-1032
devin@axfordrealestate.ca
Brokerage office 778-355-0116

Tenants: devindesaulniers.ca/tenants.html
Buyers: devindesaulniers.ca/buyers.html
2326 Clarke St, Port Moody, BC V3H 1Y8